

English Ladder

Teaching Guide

That vs Which: Understanding Essential and Non-Essential Information

A concise classroom guide with lesson flow, teaching cues, and a ready-to-use answer key built around the same English Ladder concept sheet.



Grammar Concepts #12

Key Points

Summary

Visual anchor

Use the concept poster to spotlight the main language pattern in **That vs Which: Understanding Essential and Non-Essential Information** and keep the explanation visible during practice and discussion.

ENGLISH LADDER

Concept #12 ▶ **That vs Which**

When the information included **is essential** to the meaning of a sentence, we use **"that"** without commas.

When the information included **is not essential** to the meaning of a sentence, we use **"which"** with commas.

The shape **that** is red is called a "cube".



The shape, **which** is red, is a cube.



The tool **that** is completely silver is called a "wrench".



The tool, **which** is completely silver, is a wrench.



The animal **that** has big ears is an elephant.



The animal, **which** has a hump, is a camel.



* If the subject is a person, the word "who" is used in both cases. But commas are still used when the information is not essential.

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At a Glance

Lesson focus That vs Which: Understanding Essential and Non-Essential Information	Suggested timing 45-60 minutes
Core objective Students explain the target pattern clearly and apply it accurately in controlled practice and discussion.	Materials Student PDF, the concept image, board space, and time for partner checking.

Suggested Lesson Flow

Warm-up	Display the concept image and ask learners to predict the rule behind That vs Which: Understanding Essential and Non-Essential Information before reading the explanation.
Model	Walk through the Core Idea and the sections on Key Points, Summary. Pause after each part so students can restate the pattern in plain English.
Guided practice	Project two or three examples from the concept sheet and ask pairs to explain why each choice works, not just what the answer is.
Independent work	Assign the 24 practice items for quiet work, partner checking, and final feedback.
Closure	Ask students to create one new sentence or mini-example of their own that follows the same pattern.



Likely Learner Errors

- Learners may overgeneralize the first pattern they notice. Keep returning to **Key Points, Summary** and ask students to explain what changes from one example to the next.
- Long explanations can hide the signal word or structure. Have students underline the exact phrase that tells them which form, pattern, or response is needed.
- If students can choose an answer but cannot explain it, ask them to justify their choice using words taken directly from the concept sheet.

Differentiation and Delivery Notes

- Support: teach one section at a time, then send students back to **the examples** or the practice set so they can apply the same rule immediately.
- Pair work: let students compare answers aloud before you reveal the key. The explanation step is as important as the final answer.
- Extension: ask stronger students to write two fresh examples or a short dialogue that uses the same target language accurately.

Model Language from the Concept Sheet

- The shape that is red is called a "cube". Here, "that is red" is essential because it specifies which shape is being referred to.
- The tool that is completely silver is called a "wrench". "That is completely silver" is essential to identify the specific tool.
- The animal that has big ears is an elephant. "That has big ears" is essential to specify which animal.
- The book that has a blue cover is mine.
- The car that is parked outside belongs to John.
- The student that studies the most often gets the best grades.



Answer Key

Use this key for whole-class feedback or fast marking.

ITEM 01

The house that is on the corner is blue.

ITEM 02

The car, which is red, is very fast.

ITEM 03

The book that I borrowed was excellent.

ITEM 04

My phone, which is very old, still works fine.

ITEM 05

The movie that we watched last night was scary.

ITEM 06

The flowers, which are on the table, are for you.

ITEM 07

The student that studies the hardest usually succeeds.

ITEM 08

My computer, which is very fast, helps me work efficiently.

ITEM 09

The song that she sang was beautiful.

ITEM 10

The cake, which was chocolate, was delicious.

ITEM 11

The book that has a red cover is mine.

ITEM 12

The car, which is parked outside, is my sister's.

ITEM 13

The dog that barked all night kept us awake.

ITEM 14

My brother, who lives in New York, is visiting us.



ITEM 15

The bike that I ride is very old.

ITEM 16

The movie, which stars my favorite actor, is a hit.

ITEM 17

The building that collapsed was very old.

ITEM 18

The painting, which was stolen, is very valuable.

ITEM 19

The restaurant that we went to was expensive.

ITEM 20

The shoes, which are black, are very comfortable.

ITEM 21

The film that we watched last night was interesting.

ITEM 22

The tree, which is very old, provides a lot of shade.

ITEM 23

The cat that caught the mouse is very clever.

ITEM 24

The teacher, who assigned the homework, is very strict.